Ford Motor Company

# Service Recall Bulletin

March 2000

**TO:** All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

**SUBJECT:** **Safety Recall 00S03**: 1996 through 1998 Model Year Ford Contour and Mercury Mystique Vehicles – Brake Pressure Control Reducing Valve Replacement

## AFFECTED VEHICLES

All 1996 through 1998 Model Year Ford Contour and Mercury Mystique Vehicles without Anti-Lock Braking System (ABS) built on or after 4/1/1996 at the Kansas City Assembly Plant and built on or after 4/15/96 at the Cuautitlan Mexico Assembly Plant.

## REASON FOR RECALL

In some of the affected vehicles, one or both of the brake Pressure Control Reducing Valves (PCRV) may malfunction due to corrosion. If both PCRVs malfunction, both rear wheels may lock up when braking, potentially resulting in loss of control.

## SERVICE ACTION

On all affected vehicles, dealers will replace both PCRVs with redesigned PCRVs that offer improved corrosion protection.

## ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information

## QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

**Safety Recall 00S03**
Certain 1996 through 1998 Model Year Ford Contour and Mercury Mystique Vehicles
Brake Pressure Control Reducing Valve (PCRV) Replacement

## OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

## PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

## PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC) or by FAX. Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

## DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

## REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

## CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII Manual for claims preparation and submission information.

## OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer.) Refer to ACESII Manual for Refund information.

## RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are not approved for this program.

## PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for "Parts Retention and Return Procedures".

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Certain 1996 through 1998 Model Year Ford Contour and Mercury Mystique Vehicles
Brake Pressure Control Reducing Valve (PCRV) Replacement

## LABOR ALLOWANCES

| Description | Labor Operation | Labor Time |
|---|---|---|
| **** Affected 1996 Vehicles Without Rear Mounted PCRVs**. Inspect For Presence Of Rear Mounted PCRVs And Return Car To Customer When Vehicle Is Not Equipped With Rear Mounted PCRV | 00S03A | 0.2 Hour |
| **** Affected 1996 Vehicles With Rear Mounted PCRVs And All Affected 1997 And 1998 Vehicles**. Replace Both Rear Mounted Brake Pressure Control Reducing Valves (PCRV) And Bleed The Brakes. | 00S03B | 0.7 Hour |
| Administrative Allowance | Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN" | 0.1 Hour |

****** Affected 1996 Model Year vehicles may or may not be equipped with rear mounted PCRVs. Vehicles without rear mounted PCRVs do not require service. Return the vehicle to the customer. Be sure to use the appropriate Labor Operation as indicated in the chart.

## PARTS REQUIREMENTS

### Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Stock Orders | Effective immediately | Normal order process |
| Interim Orders | Effective immediately | Normal order process |
| Emergency Orders | Before May 1, 2000 | Call 1-800-325-5621 |
| Emergency Orders | On or after May 1, 2000 | Normal order process |

| Part Number | Description | Quantity |
|---|---|---|
| XS7Z-2C477-BA | Kit, Brake Pressure Control Reducing Valve (PCRV) consists of two PCRV valves | 1 kit per vehicle |

## DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

## EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673
www.ownerconnection.com

March 2000

00S03

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect that relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 1996 through 1998 Model Year Ford Contour and Mercury Mystique vehicles.

**What the safety issue is…**

In some of the affected vehicles, one or both of the brake Pressure Control Reducing Valves (PCRV) may malfunction due to corrosion. If both PCRVs malfunction, both rear wheels may lockup when braking, potentially resulting in loss of control.

**What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...**

Ford Motor Company will repair your Ford Contour or Mercury Mystique free of charge (parts and labor). Dealers will replace both PCRVs on your vehicle with redesigned PCRVs.

**How long will it take?**

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling requirements, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

**What we are asking you to do…**

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S03.

If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts are expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

**If you've already paid for this service…**

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

**If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…**

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

**If you have concerns…**

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

**OR**

E-mail: www.ownerconnection.com
Current E-mail response time is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

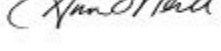
**Quality Care service is there for you all year round.**

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Again, we are sorry for the inconvenience. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs